

MEONCROSS SCHOOL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

FROM RELIGIOUS DIVISION TO THE ARMADA: HOW DID ELIZABETH SECURE HER THRONE?

*Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88 - Key
Topic 1: Queen, government and religion, 1558-69*

Scholar: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: _____

Grade	9-1 GCSE Grading Scale		
Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT1.1: The situation on Elizabeth's accession, 1558			
L2: KT1.2: The 'settlement' of religion, 1559			
L3: KT1.3: Challenge to the religious settlement			
L4: KT1.4: The problem of Mary, Queen of Scots			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: KT1.1: The situation on Elizabeth's accession, 1558

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the rigid structure of Elizabethan society, the concept of the Great Chain of Being, and the mechanics of Tudor government, including the roles of the Court, Privy Council, and Parliament.
- ☐ Analyse the intense challenges Elizabeth faced regarding her legitimacy, sixteenth-century gender prejudices against a 'Queen Regnant', and the political dilemma of marriage.
- ☐ Evaluate the interconnected domestic and foreign threats facing England in 1558, specifically severe financial weaknesses, the loss of Calais, and the dangerous 'Auld Alliance' between France and Scotland.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What did William Harvey discover?

In what year did the Black Death arrive in England?

What did Edward Jenner discover?

Who published the Germ Theory in 1861?

What was 'miasma'?

Who was Elizabeth I's father?

What was the Reformation?

Who was the monarch immediately before Elizabeth?

What religion was Mary I?

What was the 'Great Chain of Being'?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Great Chain of Being Patronage Privy Council Queen Regnant Legitimacy Debasement Auld Alliance

When Elizabeth ascended the throne in 1558, Tudor society was strictly organized according to the [.], a hierarchical structure where everyone had a fixed place. To maintain control and reward loyalty, the Queen relied heavily on the system of [.], distributing land and titles to powerful nobles. She was advised by a small, elite group of trusted ministers called the [.]. However, as an unmarried [.], she faced immense challenges, including Catholic doubts about her [.], economic ruin caused by the [.] of the coinage, and the constant foreign threat of the [.] between France and Scotland.

Q1. Vocabulary in Context: Based on the text, what does 'patronage' mean and why was it vital for Elizabeth?

Q2. Causal Linkage: How did Elizabeth's gender directly cause a 'crisis of legitimacy' upon her accession?

Q3. The 'But/Because/So' Strategy: Complete the sentence. Elizabeth inherited a massive debt, BUT...

Q4. Constrained Summary: Summarise the threat from France and Scotland in exactly three bullet points.

Q5. Diamond Ranking Challenge: Which of Elizabeth's 1558 problems (Gender, Debt, France/Scotland) was the most dangerous? Justify your choice.

Pair & Share Activity

Q6. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: What was Elizabeth's most urgent problem in 1558?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q7. Describe one feature of Elizabethan society in 1558.

Q8. Describe one feature of Elizabethan government in 1558.

Q9. Describe one feature of the financial weaknesses Elizabeth faced upon her accession in 1558.

Q10. Describe one feature of the French threat to England in 1558.

Q11. Explain why Elizabeth's legitimacy was questioned when she became queen in 1558.
Stimulus: Her parents' marriage / Mary, Queen of Scots

[12 marks • 15 mins]

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[12 marks • 15 mins]

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Q13. 'The problem of Elizabeth's legitimacy was the main problem she faced when she became queen in 1558.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Royal finances / The French threat

Q14. 'Financial weakness was Elizabeth's main problem when she became queen in 1558.'
How far do you agree? Stimulus: The Crown's debt / Elizabeth's legitimacy

 Pupil Voice

How did the events of today's lesson make you feel, and why?

General Notes

[illegible]

L2: KT1.2: The 'settlement' of religion, 1559

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the key features and impact of Elizabeth's religious settlement (1559), including the Act of Supremacy and the Act of Uniformity.
- ☐ Analyse the crucial role of the Church of England in society, specifically its function in enforcing social control, managing Church courts, and conducting visitations.
- ☐ Evaluate the nature and extent of the Puritan and Catholic challenges to the religious settlement, including the role of the nobility, the Papacy, and foreign powers.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What year did Elizabeth I become Queen?

How much debt did Mary I leave to Elizabeth?

Which French city did England lose in 1559 under the Treaty of Cateau-Cambrésis?

What was a 'Queen Regnant'?

Who was Elizabeth's mother?

Why was Elizabeth's legitimacy questioned by Catholics?

What was the 'Auld Alliance'?

What did Florence Nightingale improve?

Who discovered Penicillin by accident?

What is a 'magic bullet'?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Puritan Recusant Royal Injunctions Visitations

Your Sentence:

Q1. What was the 'Middle Way' (Via Media) intended to achieve?

Q2. Why was the Church so politically important for the government?

Q3. Who were the Puritans, and why did they hate the 'Middle Way'?

Q4. Why did Elizabeth initially treat Catholics with leniency?

Q5. The 'But/Because/So' Strategy: The Settlement was a brilliant compromise, BUT...

Pair & Share Activity

Q6. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Did the 1559 Religious Settlement actually solve the religious crisis?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q7. Describe one feature of the Act of Supremacy (1559).

Q8. Describe one feature of the Act of Uniformity (1559).

Q9. Describe one feature of the role of the Church of England in society.

Q10. Describe one feature of the Royal Injunctions of 1559.

Q11. Explain why Elizabeth introduced a Religious Settlement in 1559. Stimulus: Religious divisions in England / The 'Middle Way'

[illegible]

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

**Q12. 'Elizabeth's religious settlement was successful.' How far do you agree? Stimulus:
The 'middle way' / Catholic rebels in England**



Pupil Voice

Which part of today's lesson did you find the most difficult or confusing, and what did you do to overcome it?

General Notes

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L3: KT1.3: Challenge to the religious settlement

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the nature and extent of the Puritan challenge, focusing on their theological objections, the Crucifix Controversy, and the Vestment Controversy.
- ☐ Evaluate the Catholic challenge at home, including recusancy and the rising threat of the northern nobility.
- ☐ Analyse the existential threat from abroad, encompassing the Counter-Reformation, the 1570 Papal Bull of excommunication, and the looming shadow of foreign superpowers.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What two Acts made up Elizabeth's Religious Settlement of 1559?

What title did Elizabeth take in the Act of Supremacy?

What was the Act of Uniformity?

What was the Book of Common Prayer?

Who were the Puritans?

What were the Royal Injunctions?

How much debt did Mary I leave to Elizabeth?

Which French city did England lose in 1559?

What year did the Black Death arrive in England?

Who published the Germ Theory in 1861?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Counter-Reformation**

Q1. Causal Linkage: How did the controversy over 'Vestments' highlight the Puritan challenge?

Q2. Why did the Catholic challenge at home grow more dangerous by the late 1560s?

Q3. What was the significance of the Council of Trent?

Q4. Constrained Summary: In two sentences, explain why the 1559 settlement failed to bring permanent peace.

Pair & Share Activity

Q5. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Were the Puritans a serious threat to Elizabeth's rule?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q6. Describe one feature of the Puritan challenge to the Religious Settlement.

Q7. Describe one feature of the Catholic challenge to the Religious Settlement.

Q8. Describe one feature of recusancy in early Elizabethan England.

Q9. Explain why the Puritans challenged Elizabeth’s religious settlement. Stimulus: Vestments / Crucifixes

[12 marks • 15 mins]

[illegible]

Q10. Explain why English Catholics challenged Elizabeth's religious settlement. Stimulus: Papal authority / Catholic nobility

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This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Q11. 'The most significant challenge to Elizabeth I's religious settlement, in the years 1558–68, came from English Catholics.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Recusancy fines / The Puritan campaign against crucifixes

[illegible]



Pupil Voice

If you were teaching this lesson to Year 6, what is the ONE most important thing you would make sure they remembered?

General Notes

[illegible]

L4: KT1.4: The problem of Mary, Queen of Scots

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the strength of Mary, Queen of Scots' claim to the English throne and why English Catholics viewed her as the legitimate monarch.
- ☐ Explain the dramatic events in Scotland that forced Mary to abdicate and flee across the border into England in 1568.
- ☐ Analyse the profound dilemma Mary's arrival created for Elizabeth, including the investigation into the 'Casket Letters' and the strategic decision to keep her in captivity.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What was the 'Crucifix Controversy'?

What was the 'Vestment Controversy'?

Who was the Pope that excommunicated Elizabeth in 1570?

What was the Papal Bull of 1570?

Why did the Dutch Revolt matter to Elizabeth?

What title did Elizabeth take in the Act of Supremacy?

What was the Book of Common Prayer?

Who were the Puritans?

What was a 'Queen Regnant'?

What did Edward Jenner discover?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Abdicate Casket Letters Divine Right of Kings Conference of York

Following a scandalous marriage to the man suspected of murdering her husband, Scottish nobles rebelled against Mary, forcing her to [.] her throne in favor of her infant son. When Mary fled to England seeking Elizabeth's help, she carried the unshakeable belief that she was chosen by God under the [.]. However, Elizabeth refused to restore her to power, instead organizing the [.] to investigate Mary's alleged crimes. The primary evidence presented against Mary were the highly controversial [.], a collection of poems and documents that supposedly proved her involvement in the murder.

Q1. Why did Mary, Queen of Scots have such a strong claim to the English throne?

Q2. What catastrophic events forced Mary to flee Scotland?

Q3. The 'But/Because/So' Strategy: Mary fled to England seeking Elizabeth's help, BUT...

Q4. Diamond Ranking Challenge: What was the primary reason Mary was a 'nightmare' for Elizabeth? (A) Her royal bloodline (B) Her Catholic faith (C) Her presence in England. Justify your answer.

Pair & Share Activity

Q5. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why was Mary, Queen of Scots, such a unique problem for Elizabeth?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q6. Describe one feature of Mary, Queen of Scots' claim to the English throne.

Q7. Describe one feature of the relations between Elizabeth and Mary, Queen of Scots, in the years 1568–69.

Q8. Explain why Mary, Queen of Scots' arrival in England in 1568 created problems for Elizabeth. Stimulus: Legitimacy / Catholic alternative

[12 marks • 15 mins]

[illegible]

Q9. 'Mary Queen of Scots was the greatest threat to Elizabeth's rule.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Catholic plots / Foreign intervention

Q10. 'The main cause of tension between Elizabeth and Mary, Queen of Scots, was Mary's claim to the English throne.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Elizabeth's legitimacy / Plots

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Pupil Voice

What is one question about today's topic that we didn't answer, that you'd like to research further?

General Notes

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End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England (1558–88)

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: **1 (Low)** **2** **3** **4** **5 (Excellent)**

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)